

Word family: **borrow / borrows / borrowed / borrowing / borrower**

Base word: borrow

Forms: borrows, borrowed, borrowing

Related form: borrower

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / related noun (相關名詞)

Your sentence:

> “Of course, people go there to read, **borrow** books, and revise for exams...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **borrow** means **to take something from another person or institution for temporary use, with the intention of returning it later**.

繁體中文：借用；借入；暫時拿別人的東西來使用，之後要歸還

中文翻譯：

> “...people go there to read, **borrow** books...”

「.....人們會去那裡看書、**借書**.....」

Here:

borrow a book = 從圖書館借出一本書回去使用，之後再歸還

1. **borrow = take something temporarily and return it later (借入) — 借；借用**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To take and use something that belongs to someone else, usually for a limited time, with the intention of returning it.

Practice 1 — Original

> “People go to the library to **borrow** books.”

「人們去圖書館**借書**。」

Practice 2

> “Can I **borrow** your pen?”

「我可以****借用****你的筆嗎？」

Practice 3

> “She ****borrowed**** my umbrella for the afternoon.”

「她下午****借用了****我的雨傘。」

****borrow = 從別人那裡暫時取得某物來使用，之後再歸還****

Common:

- * borrow a book
- * borrow money
- * borrow a pen
- * borrow something from someone

2. ****borrow = receive money as a loan (借錢) — 借款；借入資金****

****Borrow**** can specifically refer to receiving money that must later be repaid.

Practice 4

> “They had to ****borrow**** money from the bank.”

「他們不得不向銀行****借錢****。」

Practice 5

> “The company ****borrowed**** heavily to expand.”

「公司為了擴展業務而大量****借款****。」

****borrow money = 向個人、銀行或其他機構取得款項，日後需要償還****

This is a major financial branch, though conceptually it still follows the same temporary-use idea.

3. ****borrow = use an idea/style/word from another source (借用) — 借鑑；借用****

****Borrow**** can also be used figuratively for ideas, styles, expressions, words, techniques, etc.

Practice 6

> “The design **borrows** ideas from traditional architecture.”

「這個設計**借鑑**了傳統建築的概念。」

Practice 7

> “English has **borrowed** many words from other languages.”

「英語從其他語言**借用了**很多詞語。」

borrow = 從其他來源採用某個想法、風格、詞語或方法

This is a genuinely important figurative sense.

4. **borrow** = take time/resources from elsewhere (抽象) — 挪用 ; 借用

Borrow can sometimes be used for time, resources, or capacity.

Practice 8

> “We may need to **borrow** time from another part of the schedule.”

「我們可能需要從時間表的其他部分**挪用**一些時間。」

Practice 9

> “The project **borrowed** resources from another department.”

「這個項目從另一個部門**借用了**資源。」

borrow = 暫時使用原本屬於其他用途或來源的資源

For strict counting, this can remain under the broad figurative “use from another source” sense.

Related form: **borrower**

A **borrower** is a person or organization that borrows something, especially money.

Practice 10

> “The **borrower** must repay the loan on time.”

「**借款人**必須按時還款。」

Practice 11

> “Library **borrowers** can renew books online.”

「圖書館**借書者**可以在網上續借書籍。」

borrower = 借入物品或金錢的人 / 機構

Important distinction: **borrow** vs **lend**

This is the most important learner distinction.

borrow

= receive/use something from someone else temporarily

lend

= give something to someone temporarily

Compare:

> “Can I **borrow** your book?”

= 我可以向你**借**這本書嗎？

> “Can you **lend** me your book?”

= 你可以把這本書**借給我**嗎？

So:

borrow = 借入

lend = 借出

Important distinction: **borrow** vs **loan**

borrow

is normally a verb.

> borrow money

loan

is usually a noun:

> take out a loan

It can also be a verb in some varieties of English, especially American English:

> loan someone money

But **lend** is the broader standard verb for giving something temporarily.

Important distinction: **borrow vs rent**

borrow

usually does not involve payment.

rent

means pay to use something temporarily.

> borrow a book from a friend

> rent a car

Different relationship.

Important distinction: **borrow vs take**

take

is broad and does not imply permission or return.

borrow

normally implies temporary use and expected return.

So:

> “I took his pen.”

could sound like you simply removed it.

> “I borrowed his pen.”

means you took it temporarily and intend to return it.

Important distinction: **borrow vs steal**

borrow

implies permission and return.

steal

means take without permission with no intention of returning.

Very different.

Grammar note: **borrow something from someone**

Natural:

> “I borrowed a book from the library.”

> “She borrowed money from her parents.”

Not:

> “borrow someone something” ❌

That pattern belongs to **lend**:

> “She lent me a book.”

Countability note

Borrow is a verb, so countability does not apply directly.

Borrower is countable:

> a borrower

> several borrowers

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **borrow**

* **borrow**s

* **borrow**ed

* **borrow**ing

* **borrow**er

The main semantic branches are:

* temporary use of a physical object

* temporary use of money

* figurative adoption of words, ideas, styles, or resources

The physical-object and money uses are closely related enough to remain under the same broad core idea of **temporarily receiving something from another source**, while linguistic/cultural borrowing is a useful figurative extension.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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borrow — object	從別人那裡暫時取得某物使用，之後歸還
borrow — money	借入資金，日後需要償還
borrow — idea/style/word	從另一來源採用、借鑑或借用想法、風格、詞語等
borrow — resources/time	暫時挪用其他來源的資源或時間
borrower	借入物品或金錢的人 / 機構

For your original sentence

> “Of course, people go there to read, **borrow** books, and revise for exams...”

The exact meaning is:

borrow = 從圖書館暫時借出書本來閱讀，之後再歸還

So:

> **borrow books**

= **借書**

For your database, I would count **3 genuinely useful core meanings** for **borrow**:

1. **temporarily take/use an object and return it**
2. **receive money as a loan**
3. **figuratively adopt ideas, words, styles, or resources from another source**

I would keep resource/time uses under #3 and keep **borrower** as a family extension rather than inflate the verb count.